

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from an article about YouTube stars:

YouTube personalities, often referred to as YouTubers, are people who are popular because of their videos on YouTube. Recently, these video stars have drawn crowds of adoring admirers at Fan Events in Asia.

Michael Stevens wows audiences with his endless knowledge of fun scientific facts. 3.2 million people tune in to hear his answers to questions like “What colour is a mirror?” or “What if every person in the world jumped at once?”

Simon and Martina Stawski became YouTube celebrities through their video channel “Eat Your Kimchi”. Each of their videos captures a realistic picture of life in South Korea and answers questions about the culture, music and food of the country from a foreigner’s point of view.

Mota, 18, is a YouTube star from California who now has her own clothing brand. At 13, she started making videos in her bedroom talking about the clothes and make-up she liked to wear and soon gained six million followers. With the fans came the brands, which started sending her free products in the hope that she would mention them in her videos.

Jenna Marbles has the 7th most subscribed channel on YouTube and the top channel operated by a woman. Marbles’ videos focus on relationships between people. Her 2010 video “How To Trick People Into Thinking You’re Good Looking” had over 5.3 million views in its first week. Her video “How To Avoid Talking To People You Don’t Want To Talk To” had approximately 34 million views as of April 2015.

Your group is going to invite one of the YouTube stars above to give a talk at your school. Decide which star you would like to invite. You may want to talk about:

- the pros and cons of each choice
- what you would like the YouTube star to talk about
- any other activities that can be included in the visit
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you and your friends watch YouTube videos?
2. What kind of YouTube videos are popular in Hong Kong?
3. Do you think young people waste too much time watching YouTube videos?
4. Why do you think YouTube stars are so popular?
5. Do you think YouTube is educational?
6. What videos would you make on YouTube?
7. Do you think YouTube will become more popular than television one day?
8. Why do you think many teenagers prefer YouTube stars to movie stars?